

In an exclusive conversation with the design team behind IKEA PS 2026, we explore how the brand is blending quirk with sophisticated functionality to redefine modern interiors

By **RIDHI KALE**

results in a change of atmosphere," shares Pott. "It makes the object more readable and easy to understand."

Living with the Prototypes

Before these products reach Indian shores, they undergo a unique ritual, home testing. Members of the design team take prototypes into their own homes to live with them. O'Brien shares a heart warming anecdote about the woven pine cabinet. "I've been home-testing it as a wardrobe for my one-year-old. The handles go all the way down, so he can open it himself. It's chaotic because he pulls everything out, but I love that he has that control and interaction with a piece that wasn't originally intended for him."

Global Vision, Local Needs

IKEA's Democratic Design doesn't ignore regional nuances. To make a collection work for both Sweden and India, the team holds annual wish list meetings where representatives from every market share local insights. "In India, you might need metal plates; in China, it's specific bowls," says O'Brien.

Designer Favourites

When asked to pick their favourite pieces from the collection, Pott chose the rocking bench and inflatable armchair for their hidden layers of joy and functionality. Axelsson opted for the versatile lamp for its ability to speak to and transform a space. While O'Brien picked the flat-pack chair for its sheer practicality and ease of movement.

As the PS 2026 collection prepares for its global launch, the team is already looking toward the horizon, proving that the most successful designs are those that serve the home while making the heart a little lighter.

